

# The power of offloading.

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# EEG during essay writing

MIT Media Lab, 2025 · 54 students

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**Brain only**      strongest connectivity

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**Search engine**      in between

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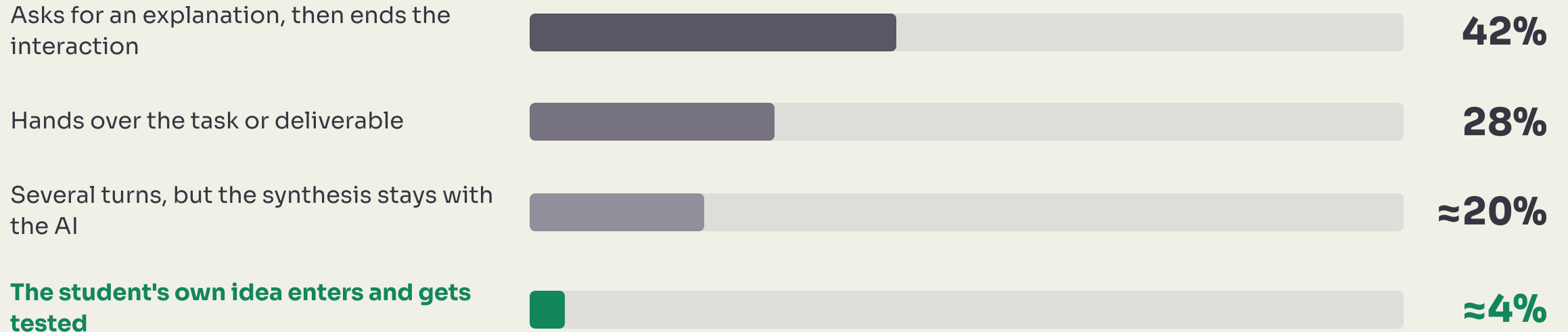
**LLM**      **weakest**

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**The LLM group showed weaker brain connectivity.**

# In search of constructive use

40,000 student messages to an AI tutor

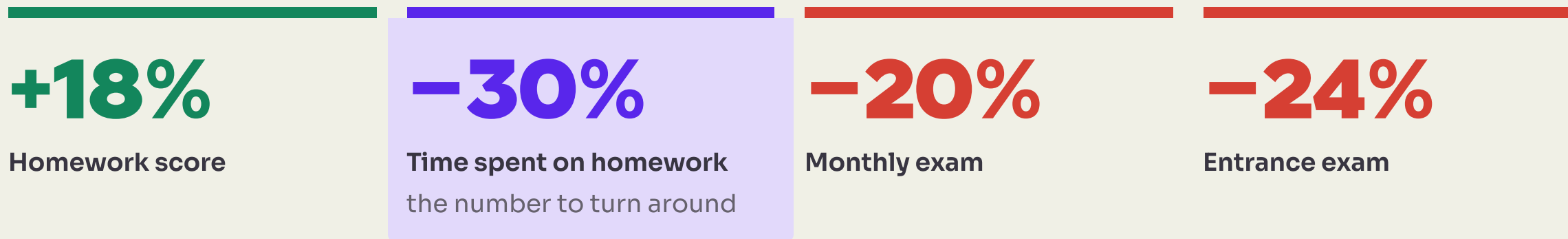


Preliminary, descriptive categorisation

Tamási, *The Power of Outsourcing*, The European Sociologist 55, 2026

# Better homework, weaker exams

26,811 Chinese secondary school students, 30 months



**+18%**

Homework score

**-30%**

Time spent on homework  
the number to turn around

**-20%**

Monthly exam

**-24%**

Entrance exam

Homework took less time because it could be offloaded to AI. **The exams showed it.**

# Current assignments reward the result.

because until now, that was what we could see

## What if we rewarded the process?

# Two programs, both built with AI

Vibe coding raises the floor, agentic engineering raises the ceiling.

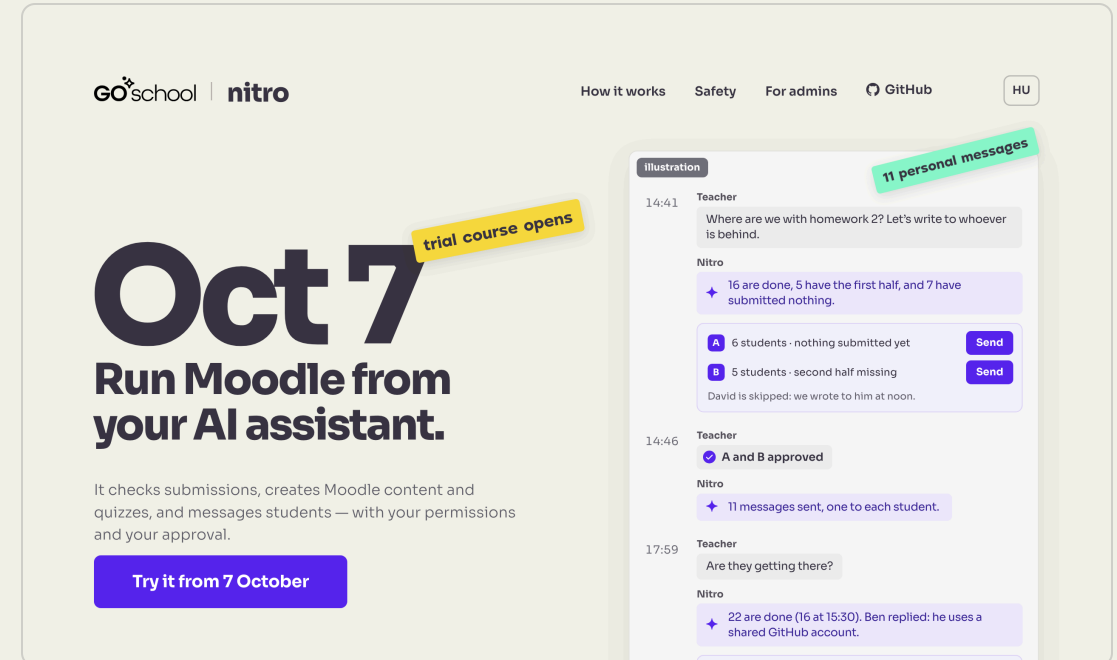
## Vibe coding

a playable 3D world from one sentence



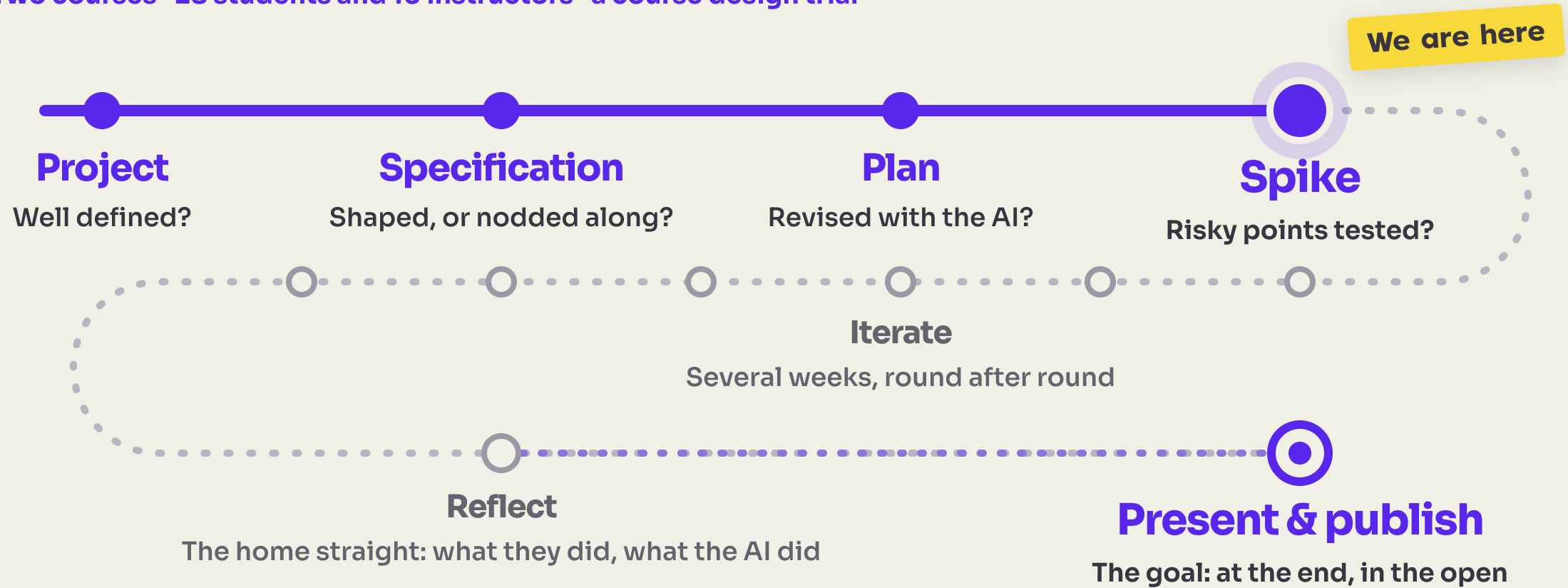
## Agentic engineering

a Moodle plugin that instructors rely on



# 44 separate projects, worked on every week

Two courses · 28 students and 16 instructors · a course design trial

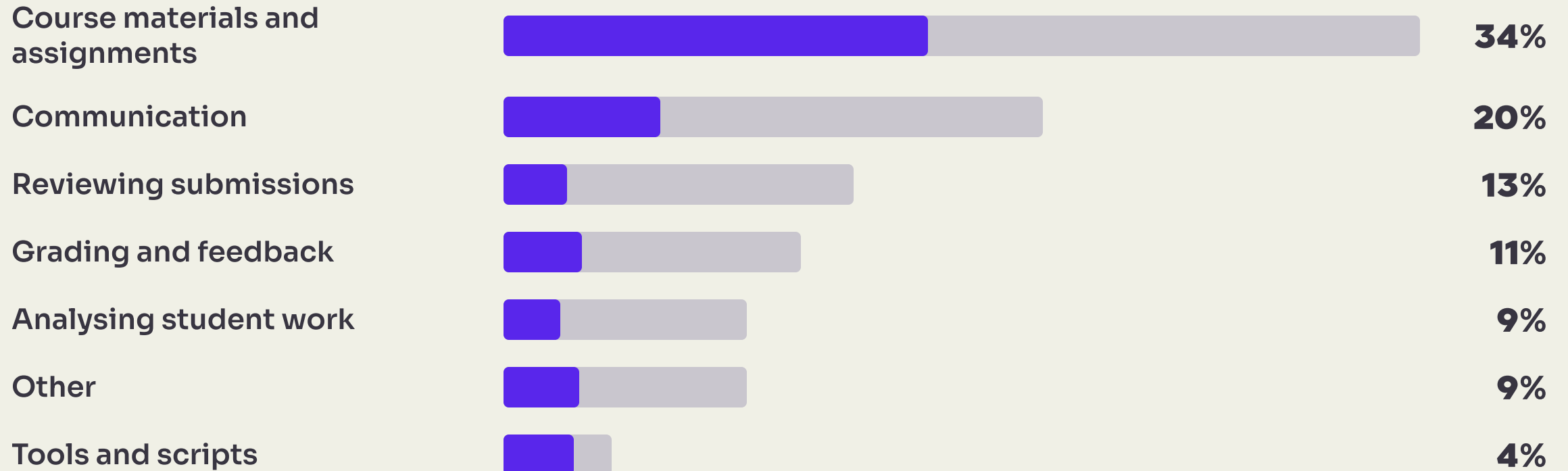


Every week, a new step on their own project. I follow it, and I support it.

# Where did my time go?

My two courses, September 2026

■ my time   ■ of this, the AI was working



# The power of offloading, in my own work

My two courses, September 2026 - about 60 hours



**15k**

words I wrote

**655k**

words the AI read

**681k**

words the AI wrote

**×89: for every word of mine, the AI read 44 and wrote 45.**

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They offload the coding.

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They build real software  
they enjoy and can show.

What stays:

**control over  
what we create.**

Working hypothesis · the courses are still running

**“Civilization advances by  
extending the number of important  
operations which we can perform  
without thinking about them.”**

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**Alfred North Whitehead**

*An Introduction to Mathematics, 1911*

# Don't fight offloading. Use its power to aim higher.

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Which of your tasks could reward  
the process instead of the result?



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discussion